

their version control system (VCS). Giving access to your VCS to a few developers is usually okay, but having to administrate accounts for hundreds of translators could be a challenge. To avoid that, some developers even decide to only accept translations with bug reports or e-mail attachments. But a developing product usually means that "strings are changing often", and with each release, translators will send a new batch of translations in. That's a lot of bug reports and e-mails.

Larger projects usually have the advantage of developing their own translation community. In which case, however, some developers feel more productive using a different type of VCS, and some others even host their project on external servers. The consequences of these approaches are either low productivity, or just a small number of translators and quality that suffers.

Finding a solution

Transifex has been developed as a solution to these issues, and to make translations dead-simple both for developers and translators. The goal with Transifex was to work as a translation proxy and handle the mechanical processes for both these groups of users, allowing them to work more efficiently and effectively.

Developers give Transifex access to their source repository. The Transifex "robot" can log in to a number of different versioning systems and grab the translation files for the translators. The latter log in to a unified, easy-to-use interface, independent of the upstream VCS type and location, and receive the translations they need. Upon translation, they can use the same interface to submit the files back to the VCS.

How it works

Richard Hughes is the software developer of PackageKit. He hosts his project in *packagekit.org*, and

needs to find a way to receive quality translations in a hassle-free way. He fires up his browser to an existing Transifex server (such as the soon-to-be-launched *transifex.net*) and registers his project there. He then receives an SSH key and uses it to create a special user on his server, with write access in the translation directories. His project is now ready to receive translations.

At this point, Richard is asked whether he'd like Transifex to scan its translation memory from other projects to bootstrap the translations of his own projects. He's delighted to see that his PO files have been translated to somewhere between 20-40 per cent with no human intervention.

Piotr is a Polish translator who loves translating free software GUIs. He has registered with Transifex and requested to receive notifications for new projects registered, which might interest him. He receives an e-mail with a direct link to the Polish PackageKit translation and another link that he can use to submit the file back.

Once the file is submitted back, Richard is notified that language translation for Polish is now at 100 per cent.

Architecture details

Under the hood, Transifex abstracts all VCSs and runs a clone/checkout on the repository. It identifies the i18n method and the translation files. Depending on the i18n method, it compares the translation files with the template file (for example, the English one) and calculates translation statistics for each one.

The management burden is removed from developers, who can concentrate on what they do best, which is writing code. Translators can use their single Transifex login account to contribute to any project they like, as long as it's registered on Transifex.

As a high-level Python application, the service includes hooks that can improve the

NACE™
move to the next level

TRAINING & CONSULTANCY

**BECOME AN
OPEN SOURCE
PROFESSIONAL.**

**IT INDUSTRY IS
WAITING FOR...**



**LINUX
APACHE
MYSQL
PHP**



**Linux Basics
Linux Administration
Linux Networking
Linux Security
OpenOffice.org 3.0**

CHENNAI

T.NAGAR : 99405 42222
ANNA NAGAR : 97909 25554
ADYAR : 97909 25550
MYLAPORE : 90030 33233
TAMBARAM : 04442059008
AMBATTUR : 94453 22869
PERAMBUR : 93808 76090
VILLIVAKKAM : 9940233360
VELLORE : 9994241383
SALEM : 9944175120
PONDICHERRY : 97918 53774
BANGALORE : +91 9940022277
HYDERABAD :
MALAKPET : 04032442998 / 99
ASHOK NAGAR : 9703333839
PANCHAGUDA : 040 64562045 / 46

www.naceedu.com